DIPLOMA PROGRAMME PRACTICE / HL / SET B

Psychology / Paper 3

Resource booklet · 105 minutes · 30 marks

Use with the matching Set B Paper 3 question booklet. The studies and data are constructed for this practice paper.

SOURCE 2

What a notification communicates

Researchers randomly assigned 64 pairs of adult strangers to two conditions. Each pair talked for eight minutes about an ordinary decision. A research phone on the table lit up twice at fixed times. In one condition the screen showed a realistic message notification without personal content. In the comparison it showed a neutral pattern of the same brightness and duration. Neither partner handled the phone. In each pair a designated listener privately rated how responsive the other person had seemed, from 1 to 7. There was one observation per pair.

Screen condition	Pairs	Mean rating	SD (scale points)
Notification	32	4.6	1.1
Neutral pattern	32	5.4	1.0

The estimated mean difference (notification minus neutral) was −0.80 scale points. Its reported 95% confidence interval was −1.33 to −0.27. The study did not record gaze direction or test actual recall of what was said.

SOURCE 3

Interviews in a service team

One service team had agreed that workers meeting a colleague could briefly explain why their phone had to remain visible. Seven volunteers from this team took part in private semi-structured interviews about recent face-to-face conversations. The interviewer recorded relationship length and the purpose of each meeting. Some volunteers said unexplained alerts made them feel that a colleague was waiting for something more important.

Two participants caring for relatives described a different experience. One said: “Once she told me what she was waiting for, the light meant someone at home might need her. I still felt she was listening.” These are constructed accounts from this team; other teams were not sampled.

SOURCE 4

Observed pauses in everyday conversations

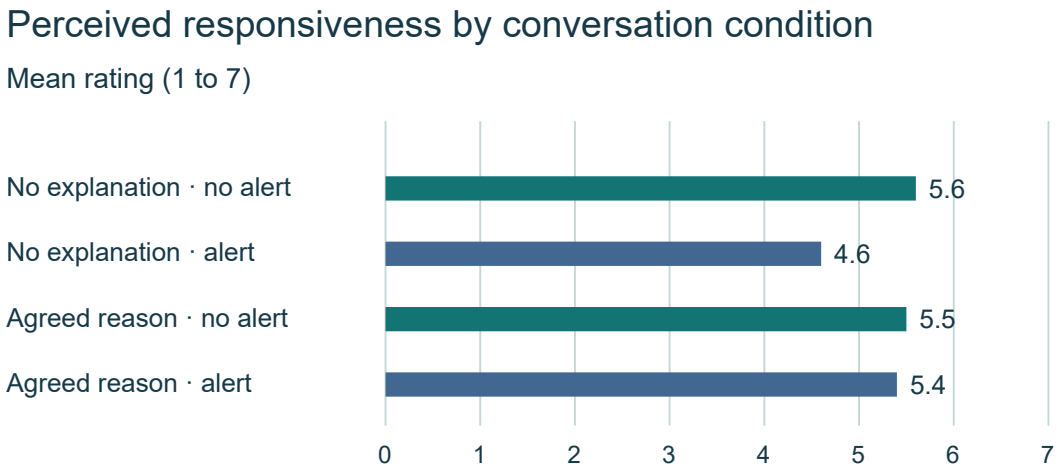
With consent, observers watched 80 adult conversations in common areas. Each conversation was counted once and classified by its first visible alert, if any. An interruption meant that the speaker stopped for at least three seconds and subsequently had to restart the point. The observers did not collect ratings of perceived responsiveness.

Alert category	Conversations	Conversations with an interruption
Alert noticed and checked	30	12
Alert noticed but ignored	25	4
No visible alert	25	3

SOURCE 5

An agreed reason for keeping a phone visible

In a separate experiment, 80 adult pairs were randomly allocated to four conditions, 20 pairs per condition. In half the pairs the speaker explained before the conversation that a transport update was expected and both partners agreed to keep the phone visible. The other pairs received no explanation. Within each group, half received one visible transport alert and half received none. Each listener rated perceived responsiveness on the same 1–7 scale. Only group means were released.



Constructed research data.